Aperture Commerce - Discovery notes

Customer: Aperture Commerce (FICTIONAL)

Prepared by Chris, Spotify account team. Every name, quotation and number in this document is invented. This expanded demo retains the original scenario and adds fictional call notes and account context. The transcript-style section is illustrative, not a recording of a real meeting.

Company details

Enterprise commerce and payments infrastructure. Employees: 6,800. Engineers: 1,350 across 94 teams; roughly 720 services. Engineering supports checkout, payment processing, merchant integrations and the internal systems used by those teams. These are approximate figures from the account notes, not an inventory we have checked.

Platform team supports shared developer tooling; product teams still run their own services. Maya: we can't maintain every service entry / runbook ourselves. Different doc habits team to team, especially after a service moves. Ownership again - came up more than once.

Opportunity: Portal Enterprise, potential $300K ARR. 60-day evaluation, stage: technical validation. The opportunity value is an account-team estimate. Budget approval and procurement timing have not been confirmed. No evaluation start date is recorded yet.

Champion: Maya Chen, Director of Platform Engineering. Account owner: Chris. Maya is coordinating the technical evaluation. We have not confirmed whether she can approve the purchase.

Alex Rivera is a platform engineer who can assess repository readiness. Jordan Lee is a developer experience engineer who can independently test service and documentation discovery. Neither has been confirmed as the operational owner of payments-api.

The first service is payments-api. Maya wants a small example the teams can recognize as useful before discussing broader rollout. The total number of services currently registered in Backstage and the number of teams actively using it were not provided.

Discovery call - transcript notes

Transcript-style notes from the fictional discovery call. Meeting date not recorded. Chris, Maya, Alex, Jordan and an SRE contributed. The SRE's name was not captured. This is an edited set of excerpts rather than a complete transcript.

[00:03] Maya Chen: Our biggest pain is that nobody can tell who owns a service. Ownership is all over the place and the runbooks are inconsistent or missing.

[00:05] Chris: When someone needs an owner today, where do they start?

[00:06] Maya Chen: Usually the wiki, then GitHub, then asking in a channel. Sometimes they find a team name that was correct before a reorganization. Someone eventually knows, but it depends on finding that person. We have not measured how long that takes.

[00:07] Maya Chen: For the pilot let's use payments-api. It's on GitHub, but I'm honestly not sure the catalog file is up to date.

[00:08] Alex Rivera: I can look at the repo and compare with the Catalog. Need the exact repo + access first, though. Haven't checked default branch or owner metadata yet.

[00:10] Maya Chen: Alex Rivera can do the initial repository readiness assessment. Jordan Lee should independently check whether people can actually find the service and its docs.

[00:11] Jordan Lee: I would like to try that before Alex changes anything. If I already know the repository name, that is a different test from someone coming in with a question about payments. We should agree what the person is trying to do.

[00:12] Chris: What would make this useful enough for you to keep going?

[00:13] Maya Chen: Someone outside the service team should be able to find payments-api, see which team is responsible and get to the right runbook. I do not want a page that looks complete but sends people to the wrong place.

Discovery call - continued

[00:14] Maya Chen: Our VP thinks Backstage is a nice-to-have, so we need something concrete in 60 days.

[00:16] Chris: Is that 60 days from today or from when the engineers have access?

[00:17] Maya Chen: We need to settle that. Access and the right people have to be in place. I do not want us to spend half the evaluation waiting on permissions.

[00:19] Maya Chen: Most teams use GitHub Actions now. I believe payments-api does too.

[00:20] SRE: I think the production deployment still goes through Jenkins. There may be an Actions workflow in the repository, but I would need to check what it actually runs.

[00:22] Alex Rivera: Both could be there. I will need someone from the service team to explain the current build and release path. Seeing a workflow file would not tell me which path is used in production.

[00:24] Maya Chen: That is fine, but we are not migrating their pipeline for this pilot. Deployments have to keep working while we do this.

[00:26] Jordan Lee: Where is the runbook people use now?

[00:27] SRE: There is a wiki page people link to. I cannot promise that every step matches the current service. The README has setup information, but I would not assume it covers an operational problem.

[00:29] Maya Chen: I would prefer the runbook next to the code so the service team can maintain it with their changes. If the wiki has something we need, we should agree what to move and what to link. I do not want two different instructions that both look current.

[00:32] Chris: Who should sign off on the owner and the runbook?

[00:33] Maya Chen: I can coordinate it, but the team responsible for the service needs to agree. Let me confirm the right people. Alex can do the assessment; that does not mean he becomes the owner.

[00:36] Jordan Lee: I can record what I tried to find and where I got stuck, then try the same task again after the changes. We have not agreed on participants or a time target.

[00:38] Maya Chen: Let's keep this to payments-api. Ownership must be visible in the Catalog before we add another service. Once this is useful, we can talk about what it would take for the next team.

Technical notes and integrations

Code is on GitHub in the aperture-commerce organization. The exact payments-api repository URL has not been supplied. It is not clear whether the service has its own repository or sits inside a larger repository. No live repository inspection has been performed for this handoff.

Docs: wiki + READMEs. SRE mentioned the wiki runbook - link didn't make it into the notes. Contents not reviewed. README may have setup steps; operational coverage still a question. Need to come back to the wiki.

CI - mostly GitHub Actions, some Jenkins still around. Maya thinks Actions for payments-api; SRE thinks production goes via Jenkins. Maybe build vs deploy? Unresolved. Ask service team, don't infer from what most teams use.

Maya is unsure whether the catalog file is up to date. We have not seen the file and should not describe it as missing or broken. Need to compare the repository metadata, what the Catalog currently shows and the service team's understanding of ownership.

The pilot must start with payments-api only. Ownership must be visible in the Catalog before any other service is added. Runbooks should live next to the code. Deployments must keep working during the pilot. These were captured as customer requirements, not completed work.

Alex will need approved repository access and the location of the current Catalog record. Jordan will need access to the discovery and documentation surfaces an ordinary developer would use. No permission grants or access checks are recorded yet.

We do not have the Backstage version, instance URL, current authentication setup or group mapping. We also do not know who maintains the existing Catalog integration. No integration change has been agreed.

The ownership problem may involve outdated team names as well as metadata. A name in a file will need to map to a team that accepts responsibility and can be contacted. Maya has not yet named that team for payments-api.

No production configuration changes, pipeline migration or broader service rollout were discussed as part of the first pilot. Any change to the service or deployment setup needs the customer's usual review.

Follow-up notes

Maya to confirm owner + runbook reviewer. Same person? Not clear from call. She can coordinate; final technical / commercial approval still unconfirmed.

Exact GitHub repo, service path if needed, Catalog location - still need these. Alex to note what he could actually read, and where access stops. Repo file isn't evidence that CI passed or a deploy worked. Link chase again.

Actions / Jenkins: back to SRE or service team. Need a safe check that deployments keep working; no health evidence or historical baseline supplied. Didn't get as far as how to check this.

Jordan wants a before attempt, before Alex changes things. Task + participants still to sort out. Coming in with a payments question vs already knowing the repo name matters here. No average discovery time, no agreed % improvement. Compare afterwards, but details open.

Wiki runbook - is it current, who can approve moving / changing it? Need an available service maintainer to review the operational steps before changes are approved. Maya still to confirm reviewer and when they can make time; no review slot recorded. If they're tied up with service work, approval waits unless the service team confirms another authorized reviewer. Don't assume Alex can sign it off. Wiki link still missing.

60 days, but from when? Start / finish not agreed. Need Maya's view on evidence for the evaluation discussion, plus the maintainer's review availability before putting dates against runbook changes. No approved milestones. Access could eat into this too - Maya raised that on the call.

Customer outcome discussed: a developer can find payments-api, identify the responsible team and reach useful operational documentation without relying on someone who already knows where everything is. We have not demonstrated this yet.

Alex's assessment and Jordan's independent check are different pieces of work. The call did not assign either engineer responsibility for every remediation or give them authority to change production.

These notes are an input to the Portal. They are not an approved implementation plan. Repository observations, developer updates and customer decisions will need their own evidence when they happen.

Internal CRM notes - not for engineers

Maya is the right champion. She is willing to coordinate the pilot and is describing a problem the engineers recognize. Still need to understand who makes the final buying decision and who can approve the evaluation outcome.

Do not share pricing or the VP comment with engineers. The VP remark is Maya's account of the situation; we have not spoken to the VP or confirmed their decision criteria directly.

Potential $300K ARR is the opportunity estimate in the account notes. No signed commitment, approved budget or confirmed commercial terms. Procurement, legal review, security review and target close date are not captured.

The executive pressure explains the desire for a concrete result in 60 days. It should not become a promise that every team or all 720 services will be onboarded in that period.

The technical handoff should focus on payments-api, clear ownership, usable documentation and continuity of deployments. Keep commercial value and relationship commentary out of developer-facing summaries and generated work.

All account information, people, call excerpts and commercial figures here are fictional demo material. The original three-page discovery PDF provided the core scenario. Additional company context and transcript excerpts were written for this expanded version; they do not come from a real customer, CRM export or meeting recording.

The exact repository, wiki and Backstage links are intentionally not invented. There are no customer credentials, personal contact details or production secrets in these notes.